Active Attack Data, version 2025: codebook

Research Ring at the ALERRT Center, Texas State University

Every variable in the Active Attack Data: what it records, its values, and how often it is missing. One row per attack, 634 attacks from 2000 through 2025, in 46 variables. Counts are from this version of the data. Released September 8, 2026 and corrected November 6, 2026. Data, figures and the current codebook at activeattackdata.org.

What counts as an active attack
An active attack occurs when an individual or individuals is actively killing or attempting to kill multiple unrelated people in a public space. The key word is *actively*: events that law enforcement learns of only after they end are excluded. Any weapon counts.

Inclusive counts
Variables ending in **_incl** use the FBI's more inclusive definition. ALERRT counts only people shot, wounded or killed by the attacker; an injury suffered while fleeing is not in **wound_tot**.

Attacker variables
Age, sex and race carry a suffix for each attacker (**age_1**, **age_2**, **age_3**). For an attack with one attacker, the **_2** and **_3** variables are empty. The order is arbitrary.

Suggested citation
Advanced Law Enforcement Rapid Response Training (ALERRT) Center. (2026). Active Attack Data (Version 2025) [Data set]. Texas State University. https://activeattackdata.org

When 6 variables

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES	MISSING
case_code Case code ID number Identifier, not a running count: cases removed on review leave gaps.	Identifier	634 distinct values	none
date Date of attack (ymd)	Date	2000-03-02 to 2025-12-26	none
year Year of attack	Number	2000 to 2025, median 2018	none
month Month of attack	Category	Jan 42, Feb 44, Mar 49, Apr 65, May 59, Jun 63, Jul 58, Aug 58, Sep 51, Oct 46, Nov 54, Dec 45	none
day Day of attack	Category	Sun 78, Mon 99, Tue 83, Wed 105, Thu 88, Fri 88, Sat 93	none
hour Hour of attack (24hr)	Number	0 to 23, median 12	none

Where 7 variables

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES	MISSING
zip_code Approximate ZIP code ZIP code nearest the attack, kept as text so leading zeros survive.	Text	606 distinct values	none
city City of attack	Text	437 distinct values	none
state State of attack	Text	50 distinct values	none
location_primary Initial attack location	Category	Medical facility 21, Office 32, Factory/ warehouse 52, School 85, Other 91, Outdoors 175, Retail 178	none

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES				MISSING
school_level Grade level of school Only recorded when location_primary is School.	Category	k-5 (elementary school) 6-8 (middle school) 9-12 (high school) university	9 9 36 24	k-8 6-12 community college school board	2 1 4 2	547 (86%)
escalated Attack began as an altercation	Category	No	586	Yes	48	none
mobile Attack occurred across multiple locations	Category	No	504	Yes	130	none

Attackers 11 variables

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES				MISSING
offender_count Number of attackers	Number	1 to 3, median 1				none
relationship Relationship between attacker(s) and victims	Category	Other Coworker No relationship	40 66 415	Indirect Student	41 72	none
age_1 Age of attacker (1) Attacker order is arbitrary; _2 and _3 are empty for one-attacker events.	Number	12 to 88, median 31				13 (2%)
age_2 Age of attacker (2)	Number	14 to 50, median 22.5				622 (98%)
age_3 Age of attacker (3)	Number	25 to 26, median 25.5				632 (100%)
sex_1 Sex of attacker (1)	Category (as text)	Male	615	Female	19	none
sex_2 Sex of attacker (2)	Category (as text)	Male	9	Female	3	622 (98%)
sex_3 Sex of attacker (3)	Category (as text)	Male	2	Female	1	631 (100%)
race_1 Race of attacker (1)	Category	Other Asian African American	4 22 185	Middle Eastern Latino Caucasian	18 86 299	20 (3%)
race_2 Race of attacker (2)	Category	Other Asian African American	0 5 5	Middle Eastern Latino Caucasian	0 1 1	622 (98%)
race_3 Race of attacker (3)	Category	Other Asian African American	0 1 1	Middle Eastern Latino Caucasian	0 0 0	632 (100%)

Weapons 5 variables

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES				MISSING
weapon_primary Most powerful weapon present (by calibre if firearm)	Category	Vehicle Shotgun Pistol	13 53 347	Knife Rifle	30 185	6 (0.9%)
weapon_pistol_tot Number of pistols present	Count (as text)	0 2 4 8	177 69 4 1	1 3 5	356 20 1	6 (0.9%)
weapon_shotgun_tot Number of shotguns present	Count (as text)	0 2	550 2	1	76	6 (0.9%)
weapon_rifle_tot Number of rifles present	Count (as text)	0 2 5	447 21 1	1 4	158 1	6 (0.9%)
weapon_tot Number of all weapons	Number	0 to 13, median 1				none

People shot, wounded and killed 15 variables

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES	MISSING
shot_tot Number of individuals shot	Number	0 to 471, median 3	none
shot_tot_incl Number of individuals shot (inclusive definition) Inclusive (FBI) definition; see the note on _incl variables.	Number	0 to 547, median 4	10 (2%)
shot_cit_tot Number of citizens shot	Number	0 to 469, median 3	none
shot_le_tot Number of law enforcement shot	Number	0 to 14, median 0	none
shot_guard_tot Number of private security/security guards shot	Number	0 to 3, median 0	none
wound_tot Number of individuals wounded	Number	0 to 413, median 2	none
wound_tot_incl Number of individuals wounded (inclusive definition) Inclusive (FBI) definition; see the note on _incl variables.	Number	0 to 489, median 2	43 (7%)
wound_cit_tot Number of citizens wounded	Number	0 to 413, median 2	none
wound_le_tot Number of law enforcement wounded	Number	0 to 25, median 0	none
wound_guard_tot Number of private security/security guards wounded	Number	0 to 2, median 0	none
kill_tot Number of individuals killed	Number	0 to 58, median 1	none
kill_tot_incl Number of individuals killed (inclusive definition) Inclusive (FBI) definition; see the note on _incl variables.	Number	0 to 58, median 1	43 (7%)
kill_cit_tot Number of citizens killed	Number	0 to 56, median 1	none
kill_le_tot Number of law enforcement killed	Number	0 to 5, median 0	none
kill_guard_tot Number of private security/security guards killed	Number	0 to 3, median 0	none

How the attack ended 2 variables

VARIABLE	TYPE	VALUES				MISSING
resolution Attack resolution	Category (as text)	Fled Suicide before police arrival Subdued by police Surrendered Shot by security	198 87 57 16 8	Shot by police Subdued by citizens Suicide after police arrival Shot by citizen Shot by off duty officer	138 60 49 15 6	none
resolved_pre_le Attack was resolved prior to law enforcement arrival Attackers who fled are counted as resolved before police arrived.	Category	Yes	368	No	266	none